

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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Dear Buzz Solutions hiring team,

I am writing about the first Forward Deployed Engineer seat in Oakland. The posting splits the job cleanly: scope the inspection workflow before signature, deploy PowerAI into the systems the utility already runs, and turn the repeated pattern into something the next deployment can reuse. I live in Emeryville. About 40% travel is a real part of this role, and I am willing to do it.

PowerAI is the visual inspection layer you describe publicly, and the \$20M Series A announced in August 2026 is aimed at scaling that product. I do not have six years in a solutions-engineering title, and I have not shipped computer vision or GIS for a utility. I have three years as the only technical person on my own accounts, plus two and a half years at IBM building pipelines under a real data constraint. I am applying because the shape of the work matches, and because the years bar should be visible rather than smoothed over.

What I would actually do in the first 90 days:

- **Pre-sales scoping:** discovery, a written in-and-out of scope, and a pilot on the customer's own files. That is how every StaffRoom engagement starts.
- **The integration:** Python or TypeScript, REST, webhooks, and data pipelines. One rebuild raised throughput 99.8% in four months. Claude Code and MCP are how I put an agent in front of a real user, with an evaluation held to 95% human agreement.
- **Field back to product:** I write the requirement an engineer can build, and I leave a playbook so the second deployment is shorter than the first.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome a conversation about what the first deployment, reporting to the CTO, needs to prove.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker